

International Relations: the changing international order 1918–1975 (J410/01–07 entry code determined by non-British depth study selected)

The focus of the period study is on the unfolding narrative of international relations from 1918–1975. Learners will study the substantial developments and issues associated with this period, in order to understand the forces and events which shaped the 20th and early 21st century world and how these forces and events have come to shape our world.

Learners will also study the ways in which some of the developments have been interpreted

differently by different historians or others (including popular interpretations) and also how and why these interpretations have sometimes changed over time.

Learners must have studied a range of interpretations in order to gain the skills necessary to analyse and evaluate unfamiliar interpretations.

Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Conflict and co-operation 1918–1939 Successes and failures of internationalist approaches in the 1920s and the retreat to nationalism in the 1930s	The Versailles Peace Settlement; the League of Nations in the 1920s; international agreements in the 1920s (Dawes Plan 1924, Locarno 1925, Kellogg-Briand 1928, Young Plan 1929); attempts at disarmament. The impact of the worldwide economic depression. Tension in Europe in the 1930s, including the failure of the League of Nations, the policy of Appeasement and outbreak of war in 1939.
The Cold War in Europe 1945–1961: Rising Tensions The changing international order after 1945 and its consequences	Actions of the USSR in Eastern Europe 1945–1948 and response of USA and its allies, including conferences at Yalta and Potsdam. The division of Germany; the Truman Doctrine and the Marshall Plan; the Berlin Blockade and Airlift. Development of NATO and the Warsaw Pact. The building of the Berlin Wall 1961 and its effects on international relations.
Cold War confrontations and conflict 1954–1975 Developing Cold War tensions and conflicts	The Cuban Missile Crisis 1962. Origins of US involvement in Vietnam 1954-65. The Vietnam War: US tactics and their consequences; Vietcong tactics and their consequences. US withdrawal from Vietnam including opposition in the USA to the war. The end of the war and its impact on international relations.

Changing interpretations of Appeasement	How and why the following have resulted in differing interpretations of appeasement: the Second World War; the Cold War; new sources of evidence c.1990 onwards.
Changing interpretations of the responsibility for the Cold War	How and why the following have resulted in differing interpretations of the Cold War: the internal culture and politics of the USSR and USA; the Vietnam War; new sources of evidence c.1990 onwards.